Bubble Shooter - 24/7 Tournament Functionality Brief

Purpose: define the always-on asynchronous tournament system for a standalone Bubble Shooter launch. The product should let users enter tournaments at any time of day, play immediately, and have results settled automatically once each fixed-player room completes or expires.

1. Core Concept

This is not real-time multiplayer. It is a 24/7 asynchronous tournament system with fixed-player rooms. Players can join a tournament tier at any time, pay the entry fee, play their round immediately, and have their score logged. The system groups results from players in the same room and settles the tournament when the room is complete.

• Each tournament tier is always available, subject to unlock level, currency balance, and configuration.

• Each room has a fixed entrant cap, default 5 players.

• Players do not wait for the room to fill before playing. They start immediately after entry.

• Each room has a shared deterministic seed so every entrant receives the same board, bubble sequence, timer, and scoring rules.

• When 5 players complete, the leaderboard becomes final and payouts are made automatically.

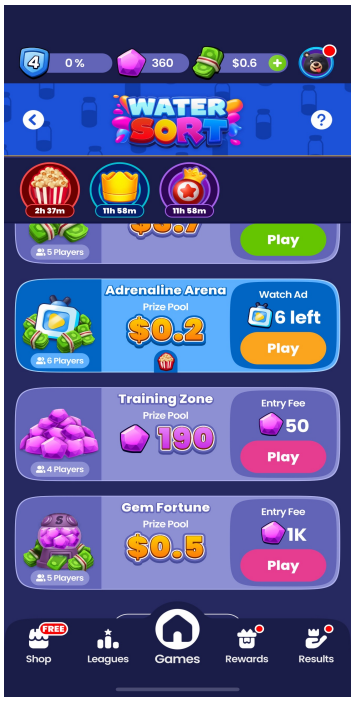
• If a room does not fill within the configured expiry window, the system should settle according to configured rules or refund entries.

2. Player Journey

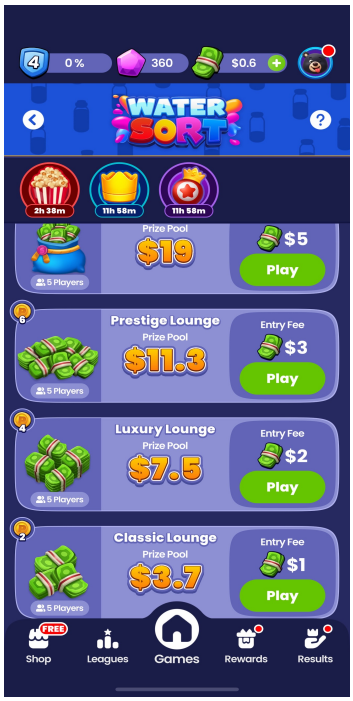
Step	Functionality
Open app	The player opens the app and lands in the main game hub.
Select game	The player selects Bubble Shooter from the game list.
Choose tournament tier	The player sees several 24/7 tournament options such as Warm Up Arena, Classic Lounge, Luxury Lounge, Prestige Lounge, and Elite Lounge.
Enter room	The player taps Play on a tier, pays the entry fee, and is assigned to the best available open room for that tier.
Play immediately	The round starts immediately. No live matchmaking wait is required.
Score logged	At the end of the round, the score and session payload are submitted to the room leaderboard.
Pending result	If fewer than 5 players have completed, the result shows as pending. The player can leave and return later.
Settlement	Once all 5 scores are in, or the room expiry rule triggers, the leaderboard finalizes and payouts are credited.
Results history	The player can open the Results tab to view placement, score, payout, and status for each room.

3. Tournament Lobby UI Reference

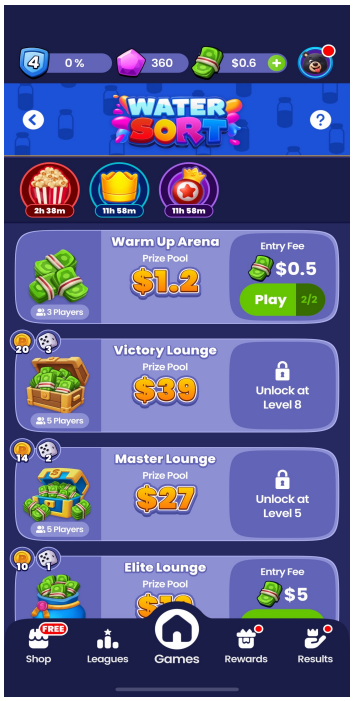
The tournament selection screen should clearly show the tournament name, player count, prize pool after rake, entry fee, unlock status, and Play button. Prize pool should be less than total collected entry fees because the platform retains rake.



Reference: gem/cash tournament list with multiple play options and prize pools.



Reference: cash lounge tiers showing entry fee, prize pool after rake, and 5-player cap.



Reference: locked tiers, level gates, and progress/unlock logic.

4. Room Creation and Fill Logic

Each stake tier should behave like an always-open queue that creates and fills rooms automatically. The user should never need to understand room IDs, but the backend should track them clearly.

• For each tier, keep a queue of open rooms. Example: Classic Lounge $1 Entry.

• When a player enters, assign them to the oldest open room with available capacity.

• If no open room exists, create a new room with a new Tournament ID and seed.

• Room capacity is fixed, default 5 players.

• A player can only submit one score per room entry.

• After a player starts, that entry is locked. Quitting or leaving may forfeit the entry depending on rules shown before play.

• Rooms should have statuses: Open, In Progress, Pending Settlement, Settled, Expired, Refunded, Cancelled.

5. 24/7 Availability and Settlement Rules

The system should be playable 24/7 even with low traffic. The app must handle partially filled rooms gracefully so users can still play immediately.

• A room remains open until it reaches 5 paid entrants or until its configured room-fill expiry occurs.

• Recommended MVP expiry window: 24 hours from first entry, configurable per tier.

• If all 5 players complete before expiry, settle instantly.

• If room expires before filling, apply a configurable rule: refund all entries, settle among completed entrants if minimum entrants reached, or move users into the next room. Choose one rule before development.

• Recommended MVP rule: if fewer than minimum entrants complete by expiry, refund entries. If minimum entrants is met, settle using configured reduced-field payout table.

• The Results tab must show status: Pending, Settled, Refunded, or Expired.

6. Entry Fee, Prize Pool and Rake

The prize pool shown to players must be the payout pool after platform rake. This means total entry fees collected should be greater than the displayed prize pool.

Lobby	Players	Entry Fee	Total Collected	Displayed Prize Pool	Approx. Rake
Warm Up Arena	5	$0.50	$2.50	$1.20	$1.30
Classic Lounge	5	$1.00	$5.00	$3.70	$1.30
Luxury Lounge	5	$2.00	$10.00	$7.50	$2.50
Prestige Lounge	5	$3.00	$15.00	$11.30	$3.70
Elite Lounge	5	$5.00	$25.00	$19.00	$6.00

Note: exact rake and payout percentages should be configurable. The examples above are for UX and economic structure, not final financial terms.

7. Payout Distribution

The payout distribution should be configurable by tier. For 5-player rooms, the default MVP can pay the top 2 or top 3 players depending on the tier.

• Example top-3 payout: 1st = 55 percent of prize pool, 2nd = 30 percent, 3rd = 15 percent.

• Example top-2 payout: 1st = 75 percent of prize pool, 2nd = 25 percent.

• 4th and 5th receive no payout unless a specific consolation reward is configured.

• All payout rules must be data-driven and configurable from a backend/admin config, not hardcoded.

8. Fairness and Deterministic Gameplay

Fairness is the core of the tournament feature. Every entrant in the same room must play the same challenge.

• Same seed per room.

• Same starting board layout.

• Same bubble sequence/order for the entire round.

• Same timer or lines remaining.

• Same scoring constants and combo rules.

• Same available power-ups if power-ups are part of the tournament mode.

• All randomness must come from the seeded generator, not device time or unseeded randomness.

• The session result should include the seed ID for verification and support review.

9. Session Result Payload

At the end of each run, the game should send a structured result object to the tournament system.

• tournament_id

• room_id

• player_id

• seed_id

• score_total

• score_base

• time_bonus

• perfect_bonus

• shots_used

• combo_max

• powerups_used

• duration_ms

• completion_status

• client_version

10. Result States and Notifications

• Pending: player completed, but room is not settled yet.

• Settled: all required scores are in and payouts were made.

• Refunded: room did not meet minimum settlement rules and entry was returned.

• Expired: room timed out; final status depends on the chosen rule.

• Notify users when their room settles, especially if they won a payout.

• Results tab should include: tournament name, entry fee, score, rank, payout, and final status.

11. Developer Implementation Notes

• Build tournament logic as a separate module from Bubble Shooter gameplay.

• Tournament module should accept game results from Bubble Shooter and later support additional games.

• Do not hardcode stake tiers, prize pools, rake, payout splits, seeds, or unlock levels.

• Use configuration tables so tournament offerings can be changed without rebuilding the app.

• The app can use local/stubbed backend during MVP development, but code should be API-ready.

12. Confirmation Requested

Please confirm you understand the 24/7 asynchronous tournament logic: players join a stake tier, start immediately, their score is logged into a 5-player room, and payouts are made automatically once the room completes or expires under the configured rules.